



Swar Sadhana

A Center For Indian Classical Music

Music is worship, it demands your respect



Our Param Pujaniya Guruji's (Padma Vibhushan Sangeet Martand Pt. Jasrajji) musings on music in general & the utility of parampara (tradition) in particular.

His given name is PANDIT JASRAJ (Kind of Fame). His other names are RASRAJ-Kind of Emotions, SANGEET MARTAND-Sun of Music, SANGEET SAMRAT-Emperor of Music, KALA SAMRAT-Emperor of Art, SURER GURU-The preceptor of notes, etc.

His mission in life is to popularize Indian classical music through his singing.

His dream-to establish Gurukul styles of schools throughout the world teaching Indian classical vocal & instrumental music for children who are the future of tomorrow; as a means to promote peace, harmony and love among world youth and have thousands of voices ring out his message; to preserve our age old culture and heritage; and to provide excellent quality all round education through our music, culture and prepare children and youth to face the unique challenges of the 21th Century.

Introduction to Indian Classical Music

Indian classical music is the most ancient and complex of all music systems in the world. Its history can be traced back to as early as 2000 BC. Today it stands as a highly developed art form, both aesthetically and scientifically. Indian classical music comprises of vocal and instrumental music.

Vocal music is the most difficult form to master. The singer who has mastered this art form has a cultivated voice that can traverse 3-31/2 octaves in his original voice and not in the falsetto. This is due to an elaborate process of voice culture, which has no parallel in any form of music through out the world.

Each singer follows his own style of rendering, depending upon his individual capacity and capability for imagination. This is because Indian classical music believes in improvising within its well defined structure of raga and tala, so much so that the same creation of the musician varies from one performance to the next. No two trained singers sing alike even if they belong to the same school or GHARANA, and have trained under the same teacher or GURU. Each musician's mode of expression is different.

Indian classical music is not written down and everything is passed on from the GURU to SHISHYA or disciple. This are is learnt only from the process of listening. Indian classical music is perceived and visualized through one's ears. There are innumerable scales and melodies that pertain to specific times of the day, to seasons, moods, emotions and feelings. This music is also a form of prayer and meditation as well as healing and relaxation.

Advantages of Music Education

The beauty, grace, and melody of Indian classical music are now universally accepted and appreciated. Many countries including those in the West have embraced it and are absorbing it more into their culture and way of life. This music is remarkably elastic in its ability to assume the form, shape and colour, which the performing musician chooses to give it. Thus, though bounded by rules, its is nevertheless unlimited in the range it affords for creative improvisation and exploration.

Indian classical music, with its origins in religion, philosophy and spiritually dates back to the ancient vedic period. It is believed to have the power to move not only human beings but plants and animals as well. Tansen, a maestro in this field who adorned the court of Mughal Emperor Akbar in the 16th century, is said to have illuminated lamps with his masterful rendition of rage DEEPAK and to have brought down the rains with his potent singing of Raga MIYAN KI MALHAR.

This Music goes beyond the narrow aspects of culture and faith. Musicians note that the deeper one's immersions is, the more generous it becomes in breath and scope. It thus offers more artistic freedom apparently all-encompassing without limits thus offering its students the scope of making their own individual contributions in this vast ocean. These dynamic aspects of freedom within a disciplined tradition ultimately lead to a sense of achievement and inner peace in every individual.

In larger perspective, studies have shown that this music helps aid the process of healing many ailments like high blood pressure, insomnia, and other sleep disorders, reducing pain, etc. It acts as a form of relaxation to stress in today's world creating peace and clam from within the individual thus making him able to function better.

The advantages of providing music education to children are limitless. Scientific studies have shown convincingly that learning music enhances accomplishments in math and science. More broadly, music sparks children's conectration, mental alertness, learning ability, self-control, self-discipline, and memory contributing to improved academic achievement. Finally, by lending a medium of new highly personal communication, music can do wonders for any child's inner self-confidence.

Class Rules and Regulations

- Be on time for your class.
- Practice regularly.
- Always pay respects to your GURU.
- Do not stretch your feet towards your GURU, any musical instrument or any performer on stage, the stage is considered as the seat of Goddess Mother Saraswati-the Goddess of knowledge.
- Do not keep any food, cups, plates, or a used cloth on you instrument or books. For dusting your instruments, use a new piece of cloth and keep it exclusively for cleaning the instrument.
- Inform your Guru in advance in case of an absence.
- Keep notes and tapes with you while in class.
- Always ask permission from your Guru if you have to leave while the class is going on.
- Take off your shoes / slippers & put it in proper place.

- Fees have to be paid by the 12th. of every month in advance. Fees will be collected on a **quarterly basis** and not on per-sitting basis.

- An enrollment fee of **Rs. 300/-** shall be payable at the time of enrollment. If a student fails to attend classes for two consecutive months, re-enrollment will be required.

- Make up classes will be given in the Guru misses class, at the convenience of both parties.

- Admission is open to all, irrespective of age or level of musical knowledge classes will be held in groups and it is entirely up to the Guru to decide a student's level and group. The Guru will form another group in case of a very big group at the same level. The Guru will upgrade a student in case he/she is eligible for intermediate or advanced level. The Guru will decide whether a student really needs a one-to-one class.

- Parents, relatives, or friends of students are requested not to sit in the class.

- Any suggestions are welcome in writing.

- Lastly, have determination, faith, commitment, regularity, and confidence in order to succeed in your endeavor.

TEACHING FACULTY
Smt. Chandra Banerjee
Pt. Sougata Banerjee